PHOENIX FIRE WATCH

Fire Watch Field Guide

Florida | New employee quick reference | Keep it with you on every shift

OFFICE
727-729-9332

Your job. The building's fire alarm or sprinkler system is out of service, so **you are the fire protection**. Patrol, spot fire and hazards early, alert the occupants, call 911, and keep the log. While you are on fire watch you have **no other duties**.

HOW TO PERFORM A FIRE WATCH

1 Start of shift

- Arrive on time, in uniform, ID visible. Bring a **charged phone**, flashlight, pen, and log sheets.
- Get briefed: **which system is down**, which areas are affected, and the **patrol interval** the Fire Marshal ordered.
- Know the **exact street address**, the site contact, and your supervisor's number.
- Walk the property first. Find every exit, stairwell, extinguisher, pull station, and the alarm panel.
- Confirm **how you will alert occupants** if the alarm is out: PA, air horn, voice, door-knocking.

2 On patrol

- Cover the **entire affected area on foot**, every round: all floors, corridors, stairwells, garages, exterior, and back-of-house rooms (electrical, mechanical, laundry, kitchen, trash, storage).
- Finish each round inside the ordered interval. Florida fire marshals commonly require a round every **15 minutes** in hotels, condos, apartments, and assembly spaces, and every **30 minutes** elsewhere. The order for your site controls.
- **Look, listen, smell:** smoke, haze, a burning odor, heat, sparking, crackling.
- Watch for hazards: blocked or locked exits, propped fire doors, trash or storage near heat, overloaded outlets, smoking, unattended cooking, hot work.
- Fix what you safely can. Report the rest to the site contact and your supervisor.
- No sleeping, headphones, or leaving the property. **Never leave post until your relief is in front of you** and briefed.

3 The log

- Log **every round as you finish it**: date, time, areas checked, what you found, your name.
- Write in ink. **Never pre-fill or back-fill.** The log is an official record the Fire Marshal can inspect at any time.
- The watch ends only when the **Fire Marshal or your supervisor** releases it, not when a repair tech says the system is fixed.

IF YOU FIND FIRE OR SMOKE

Smoke, flames, or a burning smell you cannot explain is a fire. Do steps 1 and 2 immediately.

1 ALERT
Pull the nearest alarm station if the alarm works. If it is out, shout **"FIRE"**, sound your air horn, and knock on doors as you head for the exit.

2 CALL 911
Call at once from a safe spot: *"I am the fire watch guard at [address]. There is fire/smoke at [floor, location]. The alarm/sprinkler system is out of service. The building is occupied."* Stay on the line.

3 EVACUATE
Send people to the nearest exit stair. **No elevators.** Close doors behind you. Never go through smoke. Tell firefighters where anyone is trapped.

4 EXTINGUISH
Only if 911 is called, the fire is **wastebasket-size or smaller**, your exit is behind you, and you are trained. **P.A.S.S.**: Pull, Aim at the base, Squeeze, Sweep. Not out with one extinguisher? Get out and shut the door.

5 MEET
Meet the fire department at the main entrance. Tell them where the fire is, which system is down, and who may be inside. Follow their orders.

6 REPORT
Call your supervisor and the site contact. Log when you found it, when you called 911, and what you did. Stay out until the building is cleared.

NEVER

- ✕ Delay 911 to investigate or to call a supervisor first.
- ✕ Fight a fire that is growing or is between you and the exit.
- ✕ Use an elevator or go back into a burning building.
- ✕ Silence or reset the alarm panel.

Based on the Florida Fire Prevention Code, 8th Edition (Florida editions of NFPA 1 and NFPA 101) and common Florida fire marshal fire watch requirements. The local Fire Marshal sets the patrol interval, log format, and other conditions for each site. If the Fire Marshal's order or the site post orders differ from this guide, follow the order. Training aid. Rev. 10/2026.